

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

The Phone Call



Learning Outcome

Explain customs and appropriate behaviour at work and in different countries, using a wider range of expressions and formulas.

Can Do Statements

- I can deal with a difficult customer.
- I can talk about things I am supposed to do and things that are supposed to happen.
- I can discuss how to deal with problems.

Ask your partner:

- When was the last time you had to deal with a customer? How was it?
- When you call customer service, how do you act?

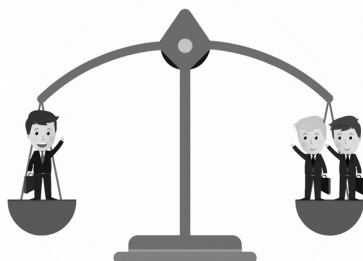




Let's Explore!

Mr. Farmani **weighs the options***.

* To "weigh the options" means to list the pros and cons before making a decision.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Janet :** Mr. Farmani. I was expecting your call. Is there anything I can help you with?
- Farmani :** Yes, indeed. You might want to take a seat and listen to what I have to say.
- Janet :** Okay. I have a stand-up meeting with my team shortly. We ought to keep it brief.
- Farmani :** I'm not satisfied with the immediate media repercussions. I've been receiving threats from human rights groups. Polygon'd better get their act together and do something about this.
- Janet :** I understand you are having a few problems, Mr. Farmani. Could you give me some more details please?
- Farmani :** I'm very dissatisfied with the service I received. The press release was supposed to alleviate the crisis. Instead, I'm getting bombarded by the press.
- Janet :** I truly understand your concerns. However, together we ought to come up with another plan. I'd better call a meeting to discuss what our next move ought to be.
- Farmani :** It's not enough. I'd like to know why nothing has been done so far. This issue had better be addressed before it's too late.
- Janet :** I completely understand how you feel, Mr. Farmani. We ought to come up with a swift and appropriate crisis communication response. We might want to hire another spokesperson.
- Farmani :** I'm not sure this is going to address the issue here. My organization's good name ought to be preserved.
- Janet :** We really appreciate the feedback. But we might want to approach this differently.
- Farmani :** What do you have in mind? It'd better be good.
- Janet :** I can assure you we'll do our best.



Let's Practice!

An irate* customer.

*"Irate" (eye-rate) means very angry.

Instructions: Select the correct answer. Practice saying the complete sentences aloud with your partner. Correct each other.

1. I'm not satisfied ...
 - a. with the immediate media repercussions.
 - b. you give me some more details please?
 - c. really appreciate the feedback.
2. I completely understand ...
 - a. together we ought to come up with another plan.
 - b. how you feel, Mr. Farmani.
 - c. really appreciate the feedback.
3. I'm very dissatisfied ...
 - a. was expecting your call.
 - b. with the service I received.
 - c. we'll do our best.



Let's Practice!

How can we deal with these problems?

Instructions: Match the halves on the left with the ones on the right to complete each sentence. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| 1. I have a stand-up meeting | a. swift response. |
| 2. Polygon had better | b. get their act together. |
| 3. I'm getting bombarded | c. with my team shortly. |
| 4. We ought to come up with a | d. by the press. |
| 5. The press release was supposed | e. to alleviate the crisis. |





Extension Activity

Responding to a difficult customer.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of a situation in which you would need to call customer service (e.g. overcharged on your credit card).
- Create an imaginary dialogue between a customer and a customer service agent.
- Use the examples for "making a complaint" and "showing understanding" to begin your sentences.
- Act out your dialogue with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I create a dialogue.

☐ ☐

I use appropriate language for making a complaint.

☐ ☐

I use appropriate language for showing understanding.

☐ ☐

I practice the dialogue with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- stand-up meeting** (expression): meeting in which participants stand in order to keep it short
e.g. I have a stand-up meeting with my team shortly.
- keep it brief** (expression): to be concise; to avoid talking a long time
e.g. We ought to keep it brief.
- get your act together** (expression): to organize yourself in order to be more effective
e.g. They had better get their act together and do something about this.
- dissatisfied (with)** (adjective): not pleased with something or someone
e.g. I'm very dissatisfied with the service I received.
- to alleviate** (verb): to make a problem or injury less severe
e.g. The press release was supposed to alleviate the crisis.
- to get bombarded** (expression): to be attacked repeatedly
e.g. I'm getting bombarded by the press.
- swift response** (expression): a quick reply
e.g. We ought to come up with a swift and appropriate crisis communication response.





Learning Points

Expressing Advice

There are many different ways to make recommendations and express advice. The modal verbs "had better", "ought to" and "might" are often used to make recommendations.

Had better

- Form: subject + had better + bare infinitive (verb without 'to')
- Meaning: "had better" is very similar in meaning to should but it is stronger because it implies a negative consequence if the advice is not followed.

Ought to

- Form: subject + ought to + bare infinitive (verb without 'to')
- Meaning: "ought to" is used for saying what you think is the right thing to do.

Might

- Form: subject + might + bare infinitive (verb without 'to')
- Meaning: "might" is used for making a suggestion or recommendation. It's not as strong as "had better". We commonly use the verb "have" with "might".

Examples:

- You might want to take a seat and listen to what I have to say.
- I thought you might want to see what I have done.
- I have a meeting so we ought to keep this chat short.
- You'd better get your act together now.
- We ought to do something about this.
- This problem had better be addressed before we lose everything.
- We ought to come up with a swift response.





Learning Points

Dealing With a Difficult Customer

Dealing with difficult customers requires a skillful use of language. Here are some expressions you can use to defuse a situation when dealing with angry customers.

Customer

Making the complaint

- I'm sorry, but I'm not satisfied with ...
- I've been ...
- I am very dissatisfied with the service I received.

Insisting

- It really isn't good enough / It's not enough.
- I'd like to know why ...

Dealing with Complaints

Showing understanding

- I truly understand your concerns.
- I completely understand ...
- I apologise for ...
- I understand you're upset about ...
- We appreciated the feedback.

Understanding the situation

- Could you give me some details, please?

Promising action

- We ought to come up with a plan.
- We might want to approach this differently.

